

Impact Medium · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

Name what you know -> Name what you do not know -> Own the gap with confidence

START HERE

When you do not know something, say so directly and then name what you do know. Do not bluff and do not apologise for not knowing.

SAY THIS

Confident Uncertain...	<i>"I do not know the answer to that — and I do not want to guess."</i>
Bounded Answer	<i>"What I can say is..."</i>
Quick Admissions	<i>"I do not know — I will find out."</i>
Calibrated Updates	<i>"Here is what is confirmed, and here is what is still assumption."</i>
Warm Honesty	<i>"I honestly do not know what I would do in your shoes."</i>

AVOID

- When the audience needs a definitive answer to proceed and further uncertainty will paralyse decision-making.
- In contexts where expressing uncertainty is read as incompetence — some cultures and hierarchies require stated confidence.
- When you actually are certain — false modesty obscures clear information.

REMEMBER

Deliver 'I do not know' in the same voice as 'I am certain'.